

NFR Cross-Review Template

Day 3 · Activity 4 handout. Cross-review another quad's Section 7, then surface the trade-offs. NFRs interact — several usually pull in opposite directions. A mature NFR section *names* its trade-offs and says how each was resolved. Two halves: the **reviewer worksheet** and the **"Known trade-offs" subsection** the author quad appends.

The four classic NFR trade-offs

Trade-off	The tension
Performance vs Observability	Heavy logging slows the hot path; light logging blinds you when it breaks
Security vs Time-to-first-value	Strict authZ blocks the new-user happy path
Compliance vs Latency	EU data-residency requirements add cross-region hops
Accessibility vs Visual polish	Some animation patterns conflict with reduced-motion / screen readers

Part 1 — Reviewer worksheet (you review THEIR Section 7)

For each NFR, judge:

Their NFR	Defense: specific or boilerplate?	Verification: real or aspirational?	Trades off with which other NFR?

At least one place where two of their NFRs pull in opposite directions:

NFR ____ (_____) vs NFR ____ (____):
the tension is _____

Part 2 — "Known trade-offs" subsection (AUTHOR quad appends to Section 7)

Name at least one explicit tension and how you resolved it — a deferred plan beats a hand-wave.

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### Known trade-offs (in this section)

- **Audit logging vs latency:** NFR-7 (full event
  logging) adds ~30ms to the
  hot path tested in NFR-1. We accept this; if hot-
  path latency becomes the
  bottleneck, we will move logging to async
  dispatch.
- **Strict RBAC vs onboarding:** NFR-10 (managers
  cannot view dispatcher
  reconciles in their first week) blocks an
  onboarding scenario. Resolved:
  managers see a read-only view in week 1; full view
  in week 2.
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Also update the review-resolution note

Extend Section 7's resolution note (adopt / defer / push back) to cover this Day-3 review, same format as the Day-2 note.